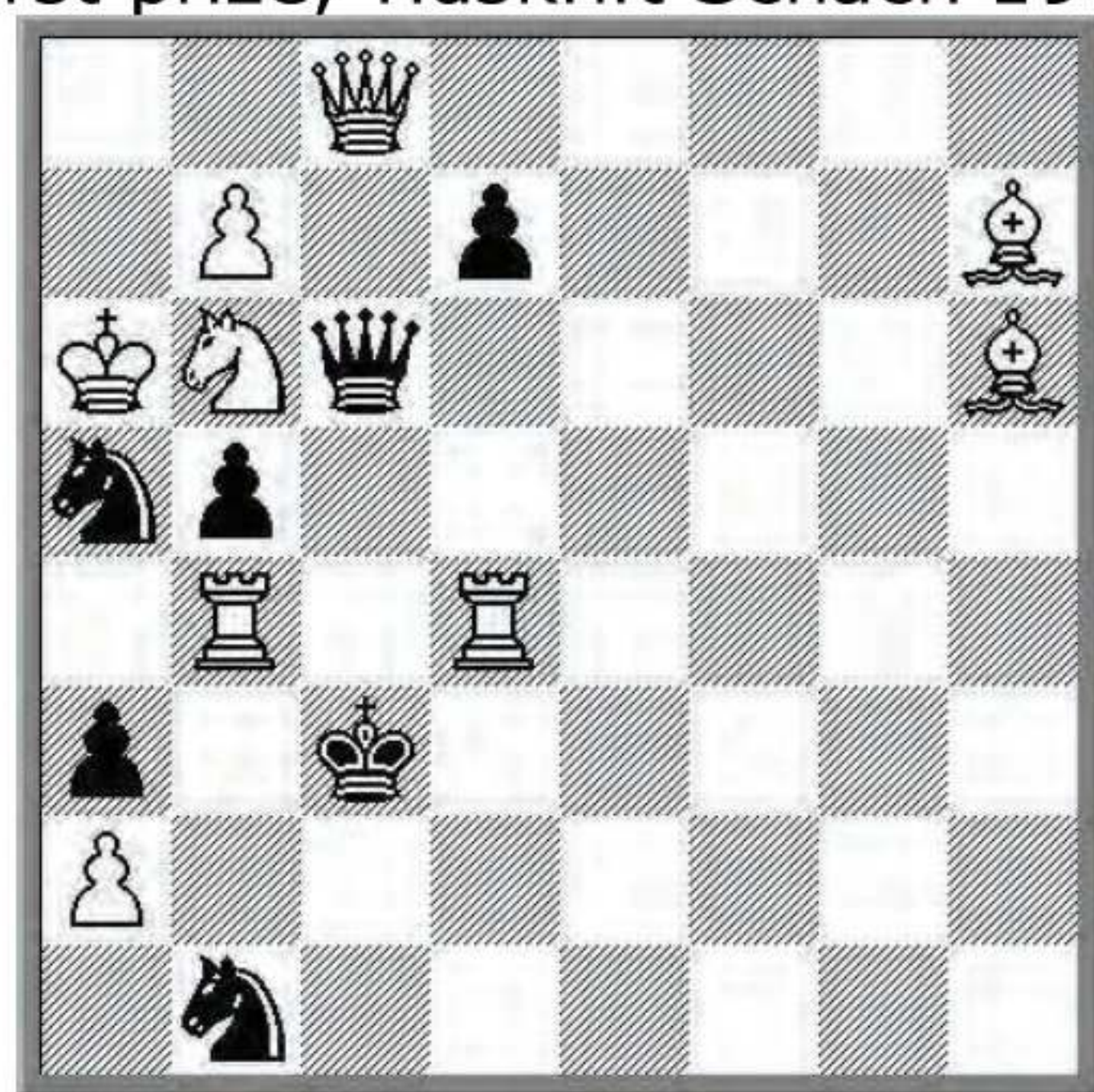


The Gamage unpin

By C.G.S.Narayanan

In Good Companion days many a theme has been named after the composer who invented it. Gamage unpin is one such theme named after the great American composer Frederick Gamage. The premise of Gamage is simple but yet ingenious. In the initial setting a black piece is pinned. One or more defences interfere with this piece which in turn is unpinned by the mating piece. The black pinned piece is invariably a black queen, black rook or a black bishop. Two such interferences are normally shown though Gamage has shown even three. The first diagram below is the oldest Gamage composed and is widely known.

Frederick Gamage
First prize, Tidskrift Schach 1911

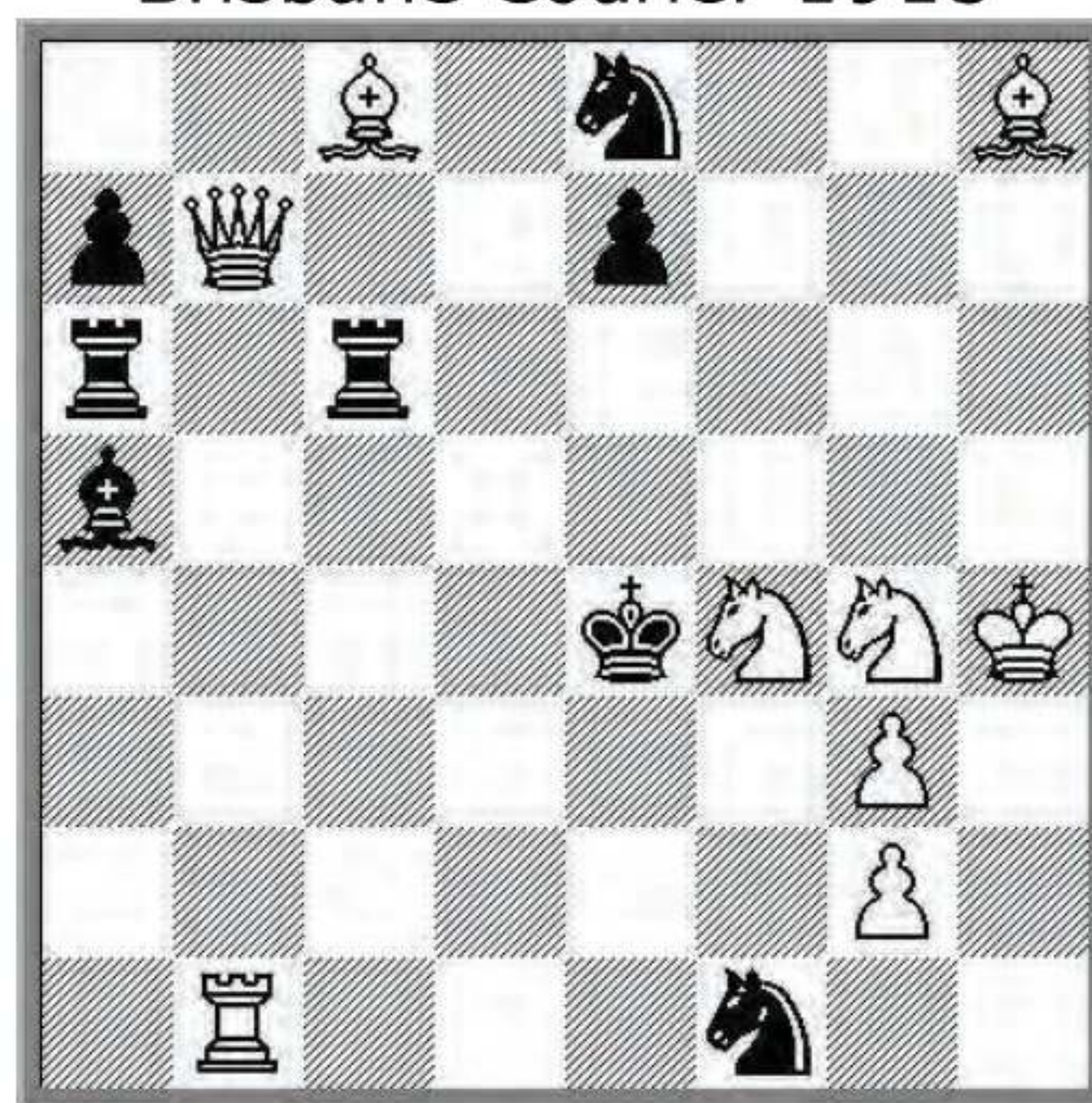


Mate in two moves

In the set position Nd2 is met by 2.Bxd2. White does not have a threatening move and so moves **1.Rh4** and waits! The two thematic variations are 1...d6 2.Qh8 and 1..d5 2.Qh3. In both cases black queen is unpinned on the mating move but interfered with by its own pawn. The other interesting variation is 1...Nd2 2.Bg7 with changed mate from the set. Mike Prcic, American composer wrote in his book on Gamage "We know that this problem

is not about set play and tries but it is interesting to note that the two tries 1.Bg7? and 1.Rg4? are defeated by 1...d6! and 1...d5!, the very same moves which produced the interferences in this revolutionary masterpiece".

F.Gamage
Brisbane Courier 1915

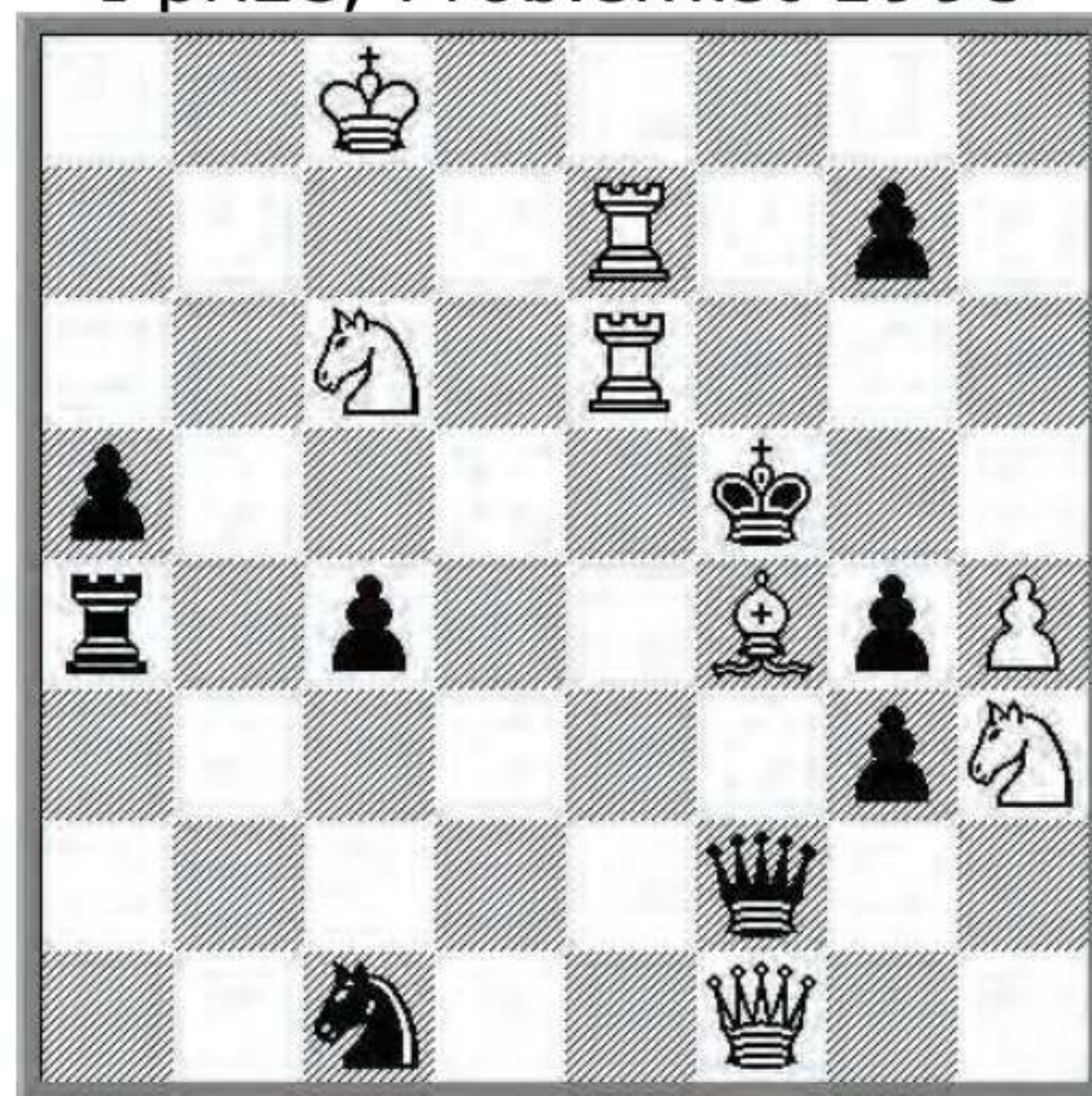


Mate in two moves

After the **key 1.Rc1!** threat 2.Rc4 there are three Gamage unpins 1...Bc3 2.Qb1; 1...Nd6 2.Qxe7 and 1...e6 (cutting off the guard for f5) 2.Qh7. 1...Bb6 2.Qxc6

The problem below for solving shows bicolour Gamage in thematic tries

M.Kovacevic
I prize, Problemist 1995



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in 'Remembering Barnes': Try 1.Qa3? (2.Nd6)Nc4/Qf8 2.Qd3/Rxg4 Bc5! Try 1.Qxf6? Bc5/Qf8 2.Qxe5/Qxg6 Nc4! Try 1.Qxb6? Nd4/Bc5 Qf8!
Key: 1.Qe6!(2.Nd6)Nd4/Bc5/Qf8 2.Rxd4/Qxe5/Qxg6.

Readers may send in their queries to
cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com